

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Part XVII settlement: official language without a national language

### ROOT QUESTION

How does one Union preserve common administration without linguistic uniformity?

### PART XVII

Chapter I: Articles 343-344 | Union language.

Chapter II: Articles 345-347 | regional languages.

Chapter III: Articles 348-349 | courts and authoritative legal texts.

Chapter IV: Articles 350-351 | grievances, minorities and Hindi development.

### CORE DISTINCTIONS

Union official language != national language.

scheduled != official everywhere | classical != scheduled | policy != Constitution.

### SETTLEMENT

Hindi in Devanagari + international form of Indian numerals

paired with statutory continuation of English and federal safeguards.

### CURRENT LAW: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026

No constitutional national language exists. Hindi is the Union official language; English continues by statute in addition to Hindi.

MUST REMEMBER: State precisely that Hindi in Devanagari is the Union's official language and that the Constitution declares no national language.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Articles 343-344 and the statutory continuation of English

### ARTICLE 343

Hindi in Devanagari = official language of Union.

International form of Indian numerals = official numeral form.

English transition period did not create an automatic 1965 switch-off.

### OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963, AS AMENDED

section 3 continues English for Union official purposes and parliamentary business.

section 3(5) uses a high-consent legislative lock for specified discontinuance.

### ARTICLE 344

President's Commission at five years and ten years from commencement.

30-member constitutional parliamentary committee: 20 Lok Sabha + 10 Rajya Sabha.

### DO NOT COLLAPSE

Article 344 committee != section 4 statutory Committee on Official Language.

### SECTION 3

English continues in addition to Hindi for specified Union purposes and parliamentary business.

### COMMUNICATION

Union to non-Hindi-official-language State -> English.

Hindi State to non-Hindi State in Hindi -> accompanying English translation.

### ADMINISTRATIVE SAFEGUARDS

section 3(2) translation | 3(3) bilingual instruments

| 3(4) efficiency, public interest and employee non-disadvantage.

### SECTION 3(5) LOCK

all specified State Legislatures + Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha.

Executive preference, one State or one House cannot discontinue the protected use.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Articles 345-347: State choice and intergovernmental communication

### ARTICLE 345

State Legislature may adopt one or more languages in use in the State, or Hindi.  
English continues until State law otherwise provides within the constitutional frame.

### ARTICLE 346

Union-State and inter-State communication follows the authorised Union language,  
subject to agreement permitting Hindi between States.

### ARTICLE 347

President may recognise a language for specified State purposes on substantial-demand grounds.

### TRAPS

Eighth-Schedule inclusion is not a prerequisite for State official-language choice.  
Article 347 is not automatic recognition or a general national-language declaration.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Articles 348-349: courts, judgments and authoritative texts

### ARTICLE 348 BASELINE

English for Supreme Court and High Court proceedings until Parliament provides otherwise.

English authoritative texts for Bills, Acts, ordinances, orders, rules and bye-laws.

### HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGS

Governor + previous presidential consent -> Hindi or State official language.

Article 348(2) expressly excludes judgments, decrees and orders.

### SECTION 7 ROUTE

authorised non-English High Court judgment/decreree/order in addition to English

-> High Court-authorised English translation.

### ARTICLE 349

historically time-bounded special procedure; not a routine present-day gate.

### LIMIT

machine or general-information translation is not automatically authoritative law.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Authoritative-text hierarchy across Constitution and statutes

### ENGLISH BASELINE

Article 348(1): court proceedings and authoritative legislative/delegated texts.

### HINDI ROUTES

1963 Act section 5: authorised Hindi Central texts.

section 6: authorised Hindi State text in specified cases.

### OTHER SCHEDULED LANGUAGES

Authoritative Texts (Central Laws) Act 1973:

Presidential authority + Official Gazette -> authoritative Central-law translation.

### HIGH COURT JUDGMENTS

section 7: authorised non-English judgment + High Court-authorised English translation.

### TRAP

translation utility, including machine output, does not itself confer authority.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Keep Union, State, court, grievance, minority-instruction, scheduled, classical and education-policy language categories separate.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Articles 350, 350A, 350B and 351: access and development

### ARTICLE 350

representation for grievance redress may use a language used in the Union or State.

### ARTICLE 350A

endeavour to provide mother-tongue instruction facilities at primary stage  
for children belonging to linguistic-minority groups.

### ARTICLE 350B

Special Officer investigates safeguards -> reports to President  
-> laid before Parliament and sent to concerned State governments.

### ARTICLE 351

Union duty to promote Hindi and develop it as a medium for India's composite culture,  
drawing vocabulary principally from Sanskrit and secondarily from other languages.

### BALANCE

promotion of Hindi operates with, not above, plural safeguards and federal consent.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: 1976 Rules: administrative routing

### RULES 1976

official portal shows amendments in 1987, 2007 and 2011; extent excludes Tamil Nadu.

### FIRST QUESTION

Central office to non-Central recipient -> Rule 3 and Region A/B/C.

Central office to Central office -> Rule 4.

### DOCUMENT CONTROLS

reply to Hindi -> Hindi | section 3(3) documents -> Hindi + English.

applications/file notes -> employee safeguards under Rules 7-8.

### CURRENT CAUTION

A/B/C are administrative communication categories, not constitutional rankings.

Do not silently modernise territorial names beyond the authoritative rule text.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Eighth Schedule and separate policy categories

### EIGHTH SCHEDULE

22 languages in the current official Constitution.

14 original -> Sindhi -> Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali -> Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhali  
-> Oriya renamed Odia.

### EFFECT

constitutional recognition and Article 344/351 relevance.

No automatic Union, State, court or school-medium status follows.

### CLASSICAL STATUS

separate Union executive recognition.

October 2024 additions brought the official count then reported to eleven.

### THREE-LANGUAGE FORMULA

education-policy framework with State implementation variation.

It is not a constitutional national-language command.

### CURRENT INSTITUTIONAL SNAPSHOT

Eighth Schedule: 22 languages. Rules portal: amendments through 2011.

Committee portal: Amit Shah as Chairperson and thirteenth report displayed.

Committee recommendations cannot override section 3's statutory safeguards.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Language cases: competence, minority context and protected choice

Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963)

medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.

D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971)

linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis.

State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014)

compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice.

DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE

legislative competence | speech/choice rights | linguistic-minority safeguards.

LIMIT

none of these decisions declares a national language or erases Article 350A.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Federal accommodation, court access and translation technology

### LEGITIMATE GOALS

administrative interoperability | citizen access | cultural recognition  
| judicial usability | educational inclusion.

### RISKS

imposition | exclusion from employment/services | translation error  
| authoritative-text confusion | weak minority facilities | digital language divide.

### TECHNOLOGY CHAIN

multilingual intake -> translation/interpretation -> human legal review  
-> authority label -> version control -> accessible publication.

### FEDERAL METHOD

consent + capacity + phased implementation + reciprocal communication.

### LIMIT

policy targets, committee recommendations and software outputs do not amend Part XVII.

#### PRELIMS FIREWALL

official != national | 22 scheduled languages | Hindi script = Devanagari  
| numerals = international form | English continuation = statute  
| Article 348(2) excludes judgments | section 7 supplies separate route  
| Article 350 grievance right | 350A instruction facility | 350B Special Officer  
| classical and three-language categories are separate.

#### 2024 PRELIMS ROUTE

21st, 71st and 92nd Amendment language additions.

#### MAINS SPINE

constitutional compromise -> Part XVII -> 1963 Act  
-> State autonomy -> court/text hierarchy -> minority safeguards  
-> category distinctions -> access technology -> federal verdict.

#### CONCLUSION

multilingual unity requires exact law, consent and authoritative parity.

LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: The 1963 Act, 1967 settlement and 1976 Rules as amended through 2011  
remain operative; the Eighth Schedule contains twenty-two languages.